

Different kinds of requirements

Users: Who are they?

- Characteristics: nationality, educational background, attitude to computers
- System use: novice, expert, casual, frequent
 - Novice: prompted, constrained, clear
 - Expert: flexibility, access/power
 - Frequent: short cuts
 - Casual/infrequent: clear menu paths

What are the users' capabilities?

Humans vary in many dimensions:

- size of hands may affect the size and positioning of input buttons
- motor abilities may affect the suitability of certain input and output devices
- height if designing a physical kiosk
- strength - a child's toy requires little strength to operate, but greater strength to change batteries
- disabilities (e.g. sight, hearing, dexterity)



Personas

- Capture a set of user characteristics (user profile)
- Not real people, but synthesised from real users
- Should not be idealised
- Bring them to life with a name, characteristics, goals, personal background
- Develop a small set of personas with one primary

Example Persona

BACKGROUND

- 15, Female
- Ongoing Private Education
- Ambitious
- Comfortable using technology to communicate

MOTIVATIONS

- Keeping in touch with her network
- Fashion/street cred
- Keeping up with peers.

FRUSTRATIONS

- Sad people trying to be 'friends' on Facebook
- Having to be in bed @ 11pm
- Being swamped in friends updates
- Missing important status updates

Ginnie

Receives private tutoring in Maths and English as these are not her strong subjects. Enjoys playing for the school's 2nd teams for netball and Lacrosse and is good at art.

She loves recording her favourite shows: ER and Sun Valley High on Sky+ and spends some of her time on her Laptop that Daddy bought her watching videos on YouTube, downloading music, keeping up to date with her friends on Facebook and chatting via MS IM to her cousin who is at University in Leeds.

She loves Ugg boots and Abercrombie & Fitch and uses the Internet to shop and find the cheapest prices.

"I want to easily hook up with my friends whilst watching TV"

